

HVAC & Texas Heat

Georgetown Homeowner Guide

Practical checklist for Central Texas summers — attic heat, AC performance, and when to call a pro.

Why Georgetown HVAC is different

Georgetown sits north of Austin in Williamson County, where cooling seasons run long and attic temperatures routinely exceed 140°F from June through September. Most homes rely on split-system AC with equipment in the attic or a closet — exactly where heat load is worst. February freeze events and late-October cold fronts mean your system also needs reliable heat, not just summer cooling.

Goal of this guide: spot early warning signs, perform safe homeowner checks, and know what to ask before you approve a repair or replacement quote.

Monthly summer checklist

- Replace or wash return-air filters (1" filters: monthly during peak AC season).
- Confirm outdoor condenser has 24" clearance — no mulch, furniture, or shrubs against the coil.
- Hose off the outdoor coil gently (power off at disconnect) if pollen and cottonwood debris pack the fins.
- Check thermostat batteries and that the schedule matches when you are actually home.
- Listen for new rattling, squealing, or clicking when the system starts — note when it happens.
- Walk the house: are any rooms 3°F+ warmer than the thermostat reading?

Warning signs — schedule service soon

- AC runs continuously but never reaches setpoint on a normal summer day.
- Ice on the refrigerant line or indoor coil (turn off AC and call — do not scrape ice).
- Water under the air handler from a clogged condensate drain.
- Burning smell, buzzing breakers, or repeated trips on the HVAC breaker.
- System short-cycles: turns on and off every few minutes.

Typical repair vs. replacement signals

Situation	Usually points to
Unit under 10 years, single failed part (capacitor, contactor, drain)	Repair after written diagnosis
Repeated refrigerant leaks or compressor failure	Compare replacement economics
15+ years old, rising summer bills, uneven rooms	Load calculation + replacement quotes
R-22 refrigerant system with major failure	Replacement (R-22 phased out)

What to ask any Georgetown HVAC company

- Texas HVAC contractor license (TDLR) and general liability insurance — in writing.
- Diagnostic fee: is it credited toward repair if you approve work?
- Written scope: parts, labor, refrigerant type, and warranty length.
- For replacement: Manual J load calculation or equivalent sizing documentation.
- Permit and inspection plan for full system changeouts in Georgetown / Williamson County.

Neighborhood notes

Sun City & single-story homes

Long duct runs and high attic heat often show up as weak airflow to distant bedrooms. Ask about duct sealing and insulation before assuming you need a larger unit.

Wolf Ranch & Teravista (newer builds)

Heat pumps and high-efficiency systems are common. Verify warranty status and whether the issue is installation-related before paying for major component swaps.

Older central Georgetown stock

Undersized ductwork and aging electrical panels can limit replacement options. Include an electrician in the conversation if your panel is full or uses outdated breakers.

Safe DIY — and what to skip

OK for homeowners: filter changes, clearing debris around the outdoor unit, checking thermostat settings, ensuring supply and return vents are open.

Call a licensed tech: refrigerant work, electrical repairs, gas furnace heat exchanger concerns, opening refrigerant lines, or any work inside the air handler on live power.

© Georgetown Home Services · georgetownhomeservices.com · Independent directory — not a contractor. For provider comparisons visit </services/hvac> and </best/top-hvac-companies-georgetown-tx> on our site.